

Luis Fernando Escobar Caba

Economist | Finance, Econometrics and Data Analysis

Professional Profile

Economist with an MSc in Corporate Finance (Summa Cum Laude) and over 10 years of experience in economic, financial and statistical analysis across the public sector, private sector and academia. Prepared official reports on the Bolivian economy at the Ministry of Economy and Public Finance, managed budgeting and fiscal analysis at the Santa Cruz Departmental Treasury, and led financial planning, budgeting and investment appraisal at INOLSA. Specialist in applied econometrics (time series, VAR, GARCH, DSGE, impact evaluation) and proficient in R, Python, EViews, Stata and Power BI. Author of 11 academic publications, twice awarded by the Central Bank of Bolivia, and graduate lecturer recognized for teaching excellence.

Professional Experience

Mar 2026–Sep 2026 **Financial Analyst**, *Industrias Oleaginosas Santa Cruz - INOLSA SRL*, Administrative and Financial Management.

- Developed financial models, scenarios, forecasts and cash-flow projections to support management planning and decision-making.
- Designed 7 KPIs and management indicators for financial and operational monitoring, notably price- and volume-effect indicators by product type tool used, e.g. Power BI.
- Prepared and controlled the company budget, keeping deviations within 10%; analyzed production costs and break-even points, identifying BOB 4 million in savings.
- Managed working capital (accounts receivable, accounts payable and inventories) and analyzed the company's leverage.
- Appraised investment projects worth USD 10 million using profitability indicators.

Jun 2021–Sep 2025 **Economic and Financial Analyst**, *Autonomous Departmental Government of Santa Cruz*, Departmental Secretariat of Finance (Treasury).

- Monitored departmental, national and international economic and fiscal variables for 4 years, producing quantitative reports and analytical notes for the Secretariat's decision-making.
- Built and maintained economic databases from official national and international sources, ensuring data integrity and traceability through validation and quality control.
- Produced monthly, quarterly and annual reports and presentations with statistical and econometric analysis for senior authorities tools: R, Python y Power BI.
- Formulated, consolidated and evaluated the Secretariat's Annual Operating Plan (POA) and budget, and monitored the execution of an institutional budget of BOB 2,657 million.

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Oct 2021–Dec 2025 **Researcher**, *Santa Cruz Departmental Association of Economists*, Economic Research Center (CIECE).

- Wrote and consolidated the first edition of the *Bolivian Economy Report*, analyzing the domestic and international macroeconomic context.
- Produced the economic growth and inflation forecasts for Bolivia published by the Association.
- Published 4 working papers (CIECE series No. 1–4) on sectoral business cycles, financial development, returns to schooling and fiscal federalism (synthetic control).
- Wrote economic outlook articles and managed the Bolivian economy database.

Feb 2020–Nov 2020 **Real Sector Analyst and Researcher**, *Ministry of Economy and Public Finance of Bolivia*, Fiscal Analysis and Studies Unit.

- Wrote and consolidated the *Bolivian Economy Annual Report (Memoria de la Economía Boliviana)*, the Ministry's official publication.
- Collected, updated and validated the national and international economic database of public institutions.
- Prepared reports, presentations and briefing notes with statistical and econometric analysis for inter-institutional technical committees on economic monitoring.
- Reviewed and validated economic analysis documents from Ministry units and other public entities, and wrote research papers.

Oct 2015–Dec 2016 **Researcher**, *Gabriel René Moreno Autonomous University (UAGRM)*, Institute of Economic and Social Research "José Ortiz Mercado".

- Produced growth and inflation forecasts, research papers, economic outlook articles and press releases.
- Refereed journal articles and managed the Bolivian economy database and the Institute's digital platform.

Consulting

Nov 2025–Dec 2025 **Professional Consultant**, *Gabriel René Moreno Autonomous University*, Registry and Procedures Department.
Conducted a statistical diagnosis of the Department's services and procedures.

2018–2019 **Professional Consultant**, *Gabriel René Moreno Autonomous University*, School of Economics.
Provided technical support for Mercosur accreditation (2019), CEUB re-accreditation and the Strategic Development Plan (2018).

May 2017–Dec 2017 **Professional Consultant**, *Gabriel René Moreno Autonomous University*, IIES "José Ortiz Mercado" and School of Economics.
Produced growth and inflation forecasts for Bolivia and a labor-market needs assessment for economists in Santa Cruz.

Nov 2017–Dec 2017 **Research Advisor**, *Universidad Nacional Ecológica*, University Research Directorate.
Refereed working papers and trained faculty in quantitative research methods.

Teaching and Academic Management

Oct 2024–Oct 2026 **Professor and Academic Coordinator**, *UAGRM Business School*, MSc in Applied Statistics.

- Courses: Data Description and Exploration, Computational Statistics I and II.
- Designed the academic content and course scheduling of the program.

May 2025–Present **Associate Professor**, *UAGRM Business School*, MSc in Corporate Finance and postgraduate diplomas.
- Courses: Financial Management, Financial Administration and Operational Control, Financial Analysis and Diagnosis, Financial Modeling, Applied Statistics.
- Teaching Excellence Award 2025 and 2026.

Feb 2026–Present **Associate Professor**, *Bolivian Catholic University*, Financial Engineering Program.
Courses: Financial Statement Analysis, Finance I.

May 2026–Jun 2026 **Professor**, *Private University of Santa Cruz (UPSA)*, Postgraduate Certificate in Results-Based Public Management.
Course: Public Budgeting and Financial Management.

Mar 2021–Jun 2021 **Academic Coordinator**, *Panamericana Business School*, University of Tarapacá Development Foundation.
Designed academic programs, scheduled faculty and course offerings, and represented the institution in Bolivia.

2013–2022 **Associate and Assistant Professor in Econometrics and Statistics**, *UAGRM (2013–2020) and Bolivian Private University (UPB, 2020–2022)*.
Courses: Econometrics I, II and III, Multivariate Statistics, Statistics I and II, Sampling, Econometrics with R/RStudio and EViews, Applied Statistics with SPSS.

Online materials Open guides and courses on GitHub: EViews book, descriptive statistics, tabular data structures, statistics course in R and data visualization with ggplot2. Course materials at lfernandoescobarc.github.io/docencia.

Education

2023 **MSc in Corporate Finance**, *UAGRM Business School*, Summa Cum Laude, honorable mention and thesis publication.
Areas: Financial Econometrics, Corporate Finance, Business Valuation.

2025 **Postgraduate Diploma in Machine Learning and Data Science**, *Bolivian Private University (UPB)*.

2020 **Postgraduate Diploma in Data Science for Public Policy**, *Torcuato Di Tella University (Argentina)*.

2020 **Postgraduate Diploma in Pedagogy, Higher Education and ICT**, *Gabriel René Moreno Autonomous University*.

2014 **Bachelor's Degree in Economics (Licenciatura)**, *Gabriel René Moreno Autonomous University*, *Graduated by academic excellence (direct graduation)*.
Concentration in Quantitative Methods.

Relevant Courses

2025 Formulation of the 2026 General State Budget – Ministry of Economy and Public Finance

2023 Formulation of the 2024 Budget – Santa Cruz School of Public Administration

2023 Causal Inference Methods for Impact Evaluation (R, Stata) – Institute for Advanced Development Studies (INESAD)

2022 Introduction to Machine Learning (Python) – Fundación Aru

2017 Credit Scoring with Statistical Techniques (SPSS, EViews) – IIES "José Ortiz Mercado"

2016 Dynamic Stochastic General Equilibrium Modeling: fiscal and monetary policy, Bayesian estimation (MATLAB) – IIES "José Ortiz Mercado"

2015 Empirical Approaches to Poverty Measurement (Stata) – Network on Inequality and Poverty

2015 Microsoft Excel – OSCORP

2015 Statistics for Decision-Making (SPSS) – Private University of Santa Cruz

Technical Skills

Statistics and data	R, Python, SPSS, Minitab, Power BI, Visual Studio
Econometrics	EViews, Stata, R
Risk	Crystal Ball, @Risk
Scientific	MATLAB
Documents	LaTeX, MS Office

Languages

Spanish	**Native**
English	**Intermediate**
Guarani	**Basic**

Awards

2026 Award for Teaching Excellence and Academic Work – UAGRM Business School.

2025 Award for Teaching Excellence and Academic Work – UAGRM Business School.

2023 Award for Research Merit – Santa Cruz Departmental Association of Economists.

2020 First Prize, National Economic Research Award ("Central Theme") – Central Bank of Bolivia (13th Meeting of Bolivian Economists).

2019 Third Prize, National Economic Research Award ("Central Theme") – Central Bank of Bolivia (12th Meeting of Bolivian Economists).

Research

Research interests: Monetary and fiscal economics, finance and applied econometrics.

Publications

Escobar C., L. F. & Banegas R., R. A. (2024). Volatilidad en los depósitos bancarios en Bolivia: GARCH simétrico y asimétrico. *Revista Latinoamericana de Desarrollo Económico*, (41), pp. 69–102.

Chalup, C. M. S. & **Escobar C., L. F.** (2023). Macroeconomic Effects of Fiscal Policy during the Covid-19 Crisis: Evidence from Bolivia at a Regional Level. *Revista de Economía del Rosario*, 26(1), 1–39.

Escobar C., L. F. (2022). La hidrovía y la salida por el Atlántico. In Peña H., P., *Al mar por el Oriente. El tren y el progreso en Santa Cruz* (pp. 165–278). Santa Cruz de la Sierra, Bolivia: Plural editores.

Banegas R., R. A., Núñez R., M. A., Salas V., J., **Escobar C., L. F.** & Esparza G., I. G. (2021). Internal and external shocks and economic policy innovations in Bolivia: a general approach. *Asian Economic and Financial Review*, 11(1), 57–77.

Escobar C., L. F. & Chalup C., M. S. (2020). Desempeño económico departamental durante la crisis del Covid-19 en Bolivia: Un enfoque VAR de frecuencia mixta con volatilidad estocástica. *Cuadernos de Investigación Económica Boliviana*, 3(1), pp. 89–110.

Banegas R., R. A., Salas V., J. & **Escobar C., L. F.** (2019). Incertidumbre internacional y transmisión de shocks en Bolivia. *Revista de Análisis del Banco Central de Bolivia*, 30, pp. 9–51.

Banegas R., R. A., Núñez R., M. A., Salas V., J., **Escobar C., L. F.** & Valdez S. (2019). Landlocked Countries, Natural Resources and Growth: The Double Economic Curse Hypothesis. *International Journal of Energy Economics and Policy*, 9(5), 1–12.

Banegas R., R. A., Núñez R., M. A. & **Escobar C., L. F.** (2017). Natural Resources, Tradable and Non-tradable Sector: An Exemplification with Bolivia, a Boom-Tradable and Non-tradable Model. *International Journal of Energy Economics and Policy*, 7(5), 68–82.

Banegas R., R. A., Salas V., J. & **Escobar C., L. F.** (2017). Shocks internos, externos e innovaciones de política económica en Bolivia: Un enfoque general (DSGE). In Banegas R., R. A., *Tópicos de crecimiento económico en Bolivia: teoría y aplicaciones* (pp. 248–290). Santa Cruz de la Sierra, Bolivia: Editorial Universitaria.

Escobar C., L. F. (2016). Fluctuaciones dinámicas entre dinero e inflación en Bolivia. *Oikos Polis, Revista Latinoamericana de Ciencias Económicas y Sociales*, 1(1), 2–49.

Escobar C., L. F. (2016). Dinero e inflación en Bolivia en los albores del siglo XXI. *Economía Coyuntural*, 1(1), 85–104.

Working Papers

Escobar C., L. F. (2022). Fluctuaciones dinámicas de los ciclos económicos sectoriales en Bolivia, 1985–2022. *CIECE Working Paper No. 1*.

Guardia P., D. & **Escobar C., L. F.** (2023). Impacto del desarrollo financiero en el crecimiento económico de Bolivia. *CIECE Working Paper No. 2*.

Ashimine M., I. & **Escobar C., L. F.** (2023). Retornos monetarios de la escolaridad: una comparación para asalariados y no asalariados. *CIECE Working Paper No. 3*.

Banegas R., R. A., **Escobar C., L. F.** & Montero K., C. M. (2025). Implicaciones económi-

cas de una Bolivia Federal: un análisis de control sintético. *CIECE Working Paper No. 4*.

References

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